Patrick Thangarajah

Simulation & FEA | Testing & Validation | Mechanical Design | Prototyping

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Summary

Recent MASc graduate in mechanical engineering with practical experience designing, building, and testing hardware systems, including sensor-integrated test setups and control circuitry. Brings simulation, DOE, and data analysis skills to support designs from concept through validation.

Skills

Design & Prototyping	SolidWorks, Onshape, Engineering Drawings, 3D Printing, Lathe, Mill, Bandsaw, Drill Press
Project Engineering & Validation	Testing & validation, DOE, troubleshooting, process improvement, technical problem-solving
Documentation & Manufacturing	SOPs, work instructions, engineering drawings, technical reports, customer specifications
Simulation & Programming	FEA, LS-DYNA, LS-PrePost, Python, C/C++

Education

Master of Applied Science in Mechanical and Mechatronics Engineering — *Waterloo, ON, Canada*

University of Waterloo — *Sep 2023 - Jul 2026*

- Research in impact mechanics, finite element analysis, and model validation
- Graduate coursework average: 90%

Bachelor of Applied Science in Mechanical Engineering, Co-op Program — *Vancouver, BC, Canada*

University of British Columbia — *Sep 2018 - May 2023*

- Biomechanics and Medical Devices Option

Experience

Graduate Research Student - Impact Mechanics and Material Characterization Group — *Waterloo, ON, Canada*

University of Waterloo — *Sep 2023 - Jul 2026*

- Validated simulations against physical tests across two configurations and 10 response channels, achieving a 0.71 average ISO 18571 correlation score
- Troubleshot model-to-test discrepancies in positioning, restraint fit, and response timing to improve agreement with physical tests
- Designed and analyzed a 104-simulation DOE-based FE parametric study evaluating the effect of seat belt restraint anchor locations on rear seat occupant response, identifying a rearward and inboard position that reduced peak chest deflection by 16% below the study average
- Automated seat belt fitting with LS-PrePost scripts, reducing repeated setup steps by 43% (7 to 4)
- Communicated findings through a master's thesis, conference paper, technical reports, and six sponsor presentations

R&D Engineer (Part-time) — *Remote*

Echoscope — *May 2023 - Sep 2023*

- Authored five manufacturing and verification procedures covering PCB assembly, wiring, software setup, and functional testing; all five were approved and used by the client
- Designed and iterated the bladder testing platform PCB, integrating pressure sensing, Arduino connections, power distribution, and motor and valve interfaces; refined component placement and routing and completed design-rule checks

Mechanical Engineering Intern — *Airdrie, AB, Canada*

GN Corporation — *Jan 2022 - Apr 2022*

- Created standardized work instructions and SOPs verified against engineering drawings and customer specifications
- Reduced fiberglass cutting waste by 50% through process analysis, and proposed a material handling workflow projected to halve pick-and-place time

Engineering Intern — *Victoria, BC, Canada*

Breathe Global — *Jul 2021 - Aug 2021*

- Redesigned the analog control circuit for a negative-pressure breathing device in Altium, using LTspice simulation to select low-cost components
- Expanded the device's achievable breathing range from 70% to 88% of target

Projects

Soft Distensible Bladder Model - Capstone Project — *Vancouver, BC, Canada*

University of British Columbia — *Sep 2022 - Apr 2023*

- Designed and built the control and data-acquisition interface for a pressurized soft-bladder test system, enabling real-time pressure/volume monitoring and automated filling/voiding cycles
- Validated pressure chamber performance using the integrated sensor and control system, demonstrating stable, repeatable pressurization at 2.2 kPa (13.8s ramp-up) up to a maximum internal bladder pressure of 4.75 kPa
- Prototyped bladder phantoms using silicone and agar, comparing pressure-volume response with literature to guide material selection

Payload Team Member — *Vancouver, BC, Canada*

UBC Unmanned Aircraft Systems (Student Design Team) — *Sep 2019 - May 2021*

- Designed and prototyped a payload drop system and rover in Onshape and SolidWorks, iterating through 3D printed proof-of-concept builds
- Reduced payload system weight by 50% by repurposing components from previous designs during concept development

Conference Presentations and Publications

- **Thangarajah, P.** (2026). *Assessment of seat belt anchor position on rear seat occupant kinematics in frontal impact using a validated THOR-5F finite element model*. Master of Applied Science thesis, University of Waterloo, Waterloo, ON, Canada. hdl.handle.net/10012/23684